

Problem 1:

You are a Quality Assurance Engineer at a cereal factory. The filling machine is set to fill boxes with 500 grams of cereal. From years of historical data and machine specifications, you know the machine's behaviour perfectly: it has a Population Standard Deviation (σ) of 5 grams. This deviation is a known property of the machine's motor vibration and doesn't change. You take a random sample of boxes to ensure the machine hasn't drifted off target (calibration check).

Population Standard Deviation (σ) = 5 g

Sample Size (n) = 50

Sample Mean ($\bar{x}$) = 498 g

Confidence Level = 95%

Answer:

$$CI = \bar{x} \pm Z \times \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}$$

$\bar{x}$: 498g

Z : 1.96 (for 95% confidence)

σ : 5g (Known Population Std Dev)

n : 50

Find the Standard Error (SE) We use the known population σ .

$$SE = \frac{5}{\sqrt{50}} = \frac{5}{7.071} \approx 0.707 \text{ grams}$$

Find the Margin of Error (ME)

$$ME = 1.96 \times 0.707 \approx 1.386 \text{ grams}$$

Construct the Interval Lower Bound: $498 - 1.39 = 496.61$ Upper Bound:

$498 + 1.39 = 499.39$

Interpretation: "We are 95% confident that the true average weight of the boxes in this production run is between 496.61g and 499.39g."

Problem 2:

1. Suppose the blood pressure in a population is normally distributed with a mean of $\mu = 120$ mmHg and a standard deviation of $\sigma = 10$ mmHg. A researcher wants to determine if a new diet affects blood pressure levels. She recruits 25 participants to follow the diet for one month and records their blood pressure levels at the end of the month:

Participant	Blood Pressure (mmHg)
1	118
2	122
3	115
4	117
5	121
6	119
7	116
8	123
9	114
10	120
11	119
12	118
13	117
14	122
15	115
16	116
17	121
18	120
19	118
20	117
21	123
22	114
23	119
24	120
25	118

Perform a one-sample z-test at a significance level of $\alpha = 0.05$ to decide whether to reject or fail to reject the null hypothesis based on the p-value and significance level.

Problem 1: One-Sample Z-Test for Blood Pressure Data

Step 1: Calculate the Sample Mean and Standard Deviation

Given the blood pressure data, we calculate:

$$\bar{x} = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{25} x_i}{25} = 118.48 \text{ mmHg}$$

The sample standard deviation is:

$$s = \sqrt{\frac{\sum_{i=1}^{25} (x_i - \bar{x})^2}{24}} = 2.6633 \text{ mmHg}$$

Step 2: Formulate Hypotheses

- Null Hypothesis (H_0): $\mu = \mu_0 = 120 \text{ mmHg}$
- Alternative Hypothesis (H_a): $\mu \neq \mu_0$

Step 3: Calculate the Z-statistic

The z-statistic is calculated using the formula:

$$z_{\text{stat}} = \frac{\bar{x} - \mu_0}{\sigma / \sqrt{n}}$$

Where:

$$\begin{aligned}\bar{x} &= 118.48 \text{ mmHg (sample mean)} \\ \mu_0 &= 120 \text{ mmHg (population mean)} \\ \sigma &= 10 \text{ mmHg (population standard deviation)} \\ n &= 25 \text{ (sample size)}\end{aligned}$$

Substituting these values into the formula gives:

$$z_{\text{stat}} = \frac{118.48 - 120}{10 / \sqrt{25}} = -0.76$$

Step 4: Determine the p-value

The p-value is determined from the z-statistic using a standard normal distribution. Since this is a two-tailed test (as we are testing for any difference, not just an increase or decrease), the p-value is calculated as:

$$p\text{-value} = 2 \times (1 - \Phi(|z_{\text{stat}}|))$$

Calculating from z-table, for our z-statistic of $z_{\text{stat}} = -0.76$, the p-value is approximately:

$$p\text{-value} = 0.4472$$

where Φ is the cumulative distribution function of the standard normal distribution.

Step 5: Decision

At a significance level of $\alpha = 0.05$, since $0.4472 > 0.05$, we fail to reject the null hypothesis.

Thus, there is not enough evidence to conclude that the new diet affects blood pressure levels in this sample.

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Reference: Steps to calculate the p-value for a z-score of -0.76 using a standard normal distribution table, follow these steps:

1. **Locate the Z-Score in the Table:** Standard normal distribution tables typically provide the cumulative probability (area under the curve to the left) for positive z-scores. For a z-score of -0.76, you would first find the cumulative probability for 0.76 (since the distribution is symmetric).
2. **Find the Cumulative Probability:** Look up 0.76 in the z-table. The table will provide the cumulative probability for this z-score. Typically, this value is around 0.7764.
3. **Calculate the P-Value for Two-Tailed Test:**
 - Since you are dealing with a two-tailed test (testing for any difference), you need to consider both tails of the distribution.
 - The cumulative probability for -0.76 is calculated as:

$$1 - 0.7764 = 0.2236$$

- For a two-tailed test, multiply this by 2 to account for both tails:

$$2 \times 0.2236 = 0.4472$$

Thus, the p-value for a z-score of -0.76 in a two-tailed test is approximately 0.4472.